

Using AI for rapid development

Simplifying the application development process is what Builder.ai is all about.

Builder.ai is a platform that helps folks build applications using predefined building blocks and uses human-assisted AI to help with the process. We spoke to Sachin Dev Duggal, the Founder of Builder.ai to exactly understand how this all works.

Q When you decide on which frameworks or APIs to support within your product, what strategy do you adopt? There's the sensible and obvious option of following whatever frameworks/APIs are already popular and then there's the option of putting your weight behind a framework/API which you believe will have promise in the next 5-10 years.

SDD: In making an assessment of which we support, we would not only factor in how widely used an API is, but how active its ongoing development is, how much new functionality is being incorporated and the number of open major defects.

We also consider adoption trends – are new users picking it up, or is the user base largely legacy consumers? This does not mean we will immediately support the new framework, but it is an indicator that it is worth evaluating. Additionally, there will be groundbreaking entrants to the market that we keep on our radar until we can assess the value in adding support for them. Finally, we evaluate risk against potential value. If there is an unproven newcomer to the market that can potentially bring immense value to the business, it may be worth accepting the risk to back that technology.



Sachin Dev Duggal, Founder, Builder.ai

In short, technologies are living, evolving organisms and ensuring that we have solutions which will meet our needs in 10 years time requires continued re-evaluation in the present.

Q There was a controversy around using humans to build apps rather than a purely AI-driven platform. How much would you say has that changed? What's the ratio of human-assisted vs purely-AI driven output?

SDD: We have always made it explicit that building an AI-powered company is very different to an AI solution company and our customer promise is the result of our own use of AI – as such we are not selling AI but a platform that benefits from it.

Additionally we never said that AI writes code nor that we use program synthesis (we are in early R&D for a cut down use case of this).

Builder.ai's mission has always been to be the connection between every great idea and a fully realised product. We've continued to deliver on that promise by providing tools for our customers, so that everyone has the power to bring their ideas to life without ever needing to write a line of code.

Our business model of Human-Assisted AI is designed to remove all repetitive processes from the "build, run & scale" journey. While our human-assisted-AI platform lets you create on-demand, tailor-made software using an exhaustive library of reusable features (500+); a very important part of this is our assembly platform and our matching platform that uses a distributed supply of talent from around the world.

Whilst the use of AI and a much wider tech stack is key as part of our scale vector; equally important is our Capacity Partner network where we aggregate software development companies and dynamically allocate them to swim lanes of projects based on our system generated grade of their teams.

We use about 1.3 people per project (equivalent to a full time person) and roughly 20% of the work is done by humans whilst the platform handles the remaining 80%.

Over time this might even drop to 10-15%. However, we will always be a Human-Assisted AI Company and the tailor made solution that we aim to provide needs this partnership to produce unique solutions for our customers.



Human-Assisted AI